

tings. A few customisable settings for different music genres would have sweetened the deal. This player also has the ability to up the tempo of the music to suit your workout pace driving you to achieve more in the gym. Sony also claims it's water resistant.

The iPod nano has a few features that some of the other players missed out on—it has a fully functional calendar, contacts, and stopwatch inbuilt. We'd have loved an alarm! iTunes used to be bundled with all iPods, but we've heard the newest iPods come without it; Apple encourages users to download it.

Performance

Somebody once said that in music, one must think with the heart and feel with the brain. If you belong to this school of thought and are extremely finicky about sound, the iPod Nano is the only way to go—Apple doesn't compromise on what they clearly feel is the only thing a PMP should really excel at. Nothing comes close to the auditory experience the iPod nano 2 GB provides on the Bose headphones. This is also the player for you if you like heavy



SanDisk Sansa e250
Unbeatable conglomerate of features, performance and price

bass, since none of the others could provide that resounding, low punch. It also had the highest volumes amongst all the players, and doesn't distort any frequency even at peak volumes. The iPod nano also has a very crisp 1.5 inch screen. How we wish for video support on this one...

The little Cowon F2 also sounds good, and comes with a good set of earbuds. The Sansa e250 sounds excellent with its bundled earbuds: clear treble, well-defined mids and good bass. In fact, the treble is the highlight, making these suitable for classical music. Plug in the Bose reference headphones, and the sound is a let down—however, as we've explained, this is a problem with mismatched impedances, and not a player issue.

However, at Rs 9,800, we feel the Cowon is a little overpriced; the Sansa e250 offers more features and double the storage space for a substantially smaller amount. There are the better performers, better lookers, and better built players amongst the competition. If only the Cowon were Rs 1,500 cheaper...

Sony's Walkman NW-S203F also performed well, though the bundled earphones look a little different. They also aren't that comfortable, and don't provide very good sound. The Bose Intra Ears were an entirely different story, and this little player will come into its own with the right pair of headphones...

Samsung's YP-K3 proved that sometimes, just sometimes, beauty can have brawn too. It

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Cool Performance



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